RAISING HANDS
Literacy Project

equalizing opportunities to read

2025 ANNUAL IMPACT REPORT



MISSION

Raising Hands Literacy Project is dedicated to empowering underserved students by providing high-quality, individualized tutoring and innovative enrichment programs. We aim to close academic gaps, build confidence, and inspire a love for learning through personalized support and hands-on experiences. By fostering equitable access to education and nurturing critical thinking and creativity, we equip students with the skills and opportunities they need to succeed in school and beyond.

As a charity our mission is to identify a need in our community and fill it- **this year, we saw a growing need for advocacy support, high quality afterschool enrichment, particularly a STEM based program, and reading support to our youngest readers.**

OFFERINGS



Free Tutoring for Low-Income Children.



Private and Small Group Tutoring



Early Literacy Classes for New and Pre-Readers



Dyslexia Screening and Comprehensive Reading & Writing Evaluations



Orton-Gillingham Training and Certification for teachers



Parent Support Services and Workshops

Watch our Promotional Video Here!

STUDENT TUTORING

2025 BY THE NUMBERS

At Raising Hands Literacy Project, we believe every child deserves access to high-quality, research-based reading instruction, regardless of their background or financial situation.

Our multi-sensory tutoring program, led by highly effective Orton-Gillingham educators, ensures struggling readers receive the individualized instruction they need to thrive.

We recruit students through partnerships with schools, community organizations, and local agencies, as well as by posting information in high-traffic areas like food banks, libraries, and community bulletin boards.

With our tutoring...

- Students **nearly doubled their reading fluency**, growing from an average of 39 to 73 words per minute in just one school year.
- Reading accuracy rose from 77% to 94%, meaning **students are reading far more confidently** and with dramatically fewer errors.
- 100% of participating teachers completed structured literacy certification, **increasing the school's capacity to deliver evidence-based reading instruction** for years to come.
- Our students made the kind of **reading gains typically seen with daily tutoring**, even though they only met twice a week.

Hours of Free Tutoring

1980



Savings to Parents

$228,000



Students Tutored

39



Free Books Distributed in English and Spanish

150

In partnership with Lisa Libraries

Savings to School Districts

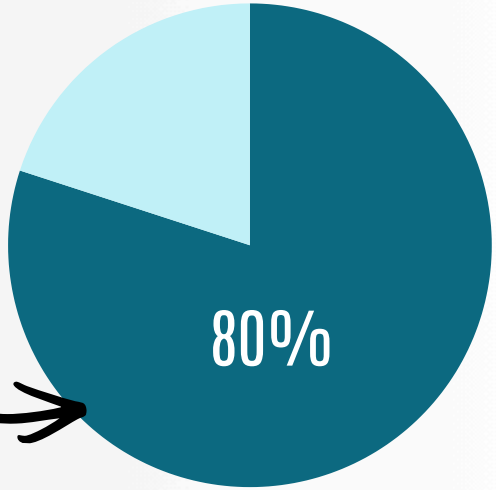
$124,800



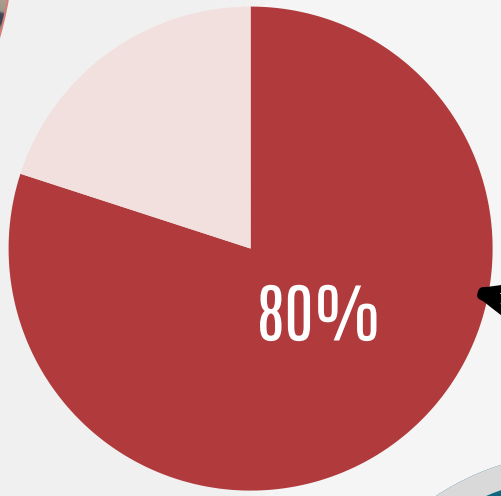
Who We Serve



Hispanic from Non-English Speaking Home



Low Income-Qualify for Free Lunch





100%
Reading Below Grade Level at our First Session

100%
Between 3-10 Yrs Old

COMMUNITY-BASED ENRICHMENT

STEM is the #1 **most requested** type of after school enrichment among families.

LITERACY LAUNDROMAT

In October 2025, we partnered with a local laundromat to create an innovative, community-based early learning opportunity for families.

Recognizing that many children spend extended time in laundromats, we launched a free, weekly early-literacy session directly inside the laundromat.

Each week, families participate in:

- Foundational literacy skill-building
- Hands-on fine motor and pre-writing activities
- Free book distribution to build home libraries

Due to strong community response, we are planning to expand the Laundromat Literacy Circle model to additional community-based locations in 2026.





STEAM

Many of the children we work with are unable to access after-school enrichment opportunities where they can showcase their strengths and develop interests outside of school. High costs and limited transportation make these programs out of reach for many families. We launched our STEAM and enrichment program to fill this gap. It's now our student's favorite part of the week!



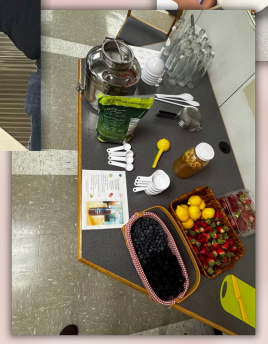
Art



Fermentation



Meterology



Low-income students are 3 times less likely to have access to STEM clubs, enrichment, or hands-on science learning outside of school.

SCREENING & ADVOCACY

1 in 5 students in U.S. public schools has a diagnosed learning or attention issue

DYSLEXIA SCREENING

Dyslexia is the most common learning disability, affecting 1 in 5 students. However, schools do not provide screening or diagnosis, and the cost for testing can average $2000 out of pocket. At our center, we make dyslexia screening more accessible for families by offering it for free through our tutoring and community programs.

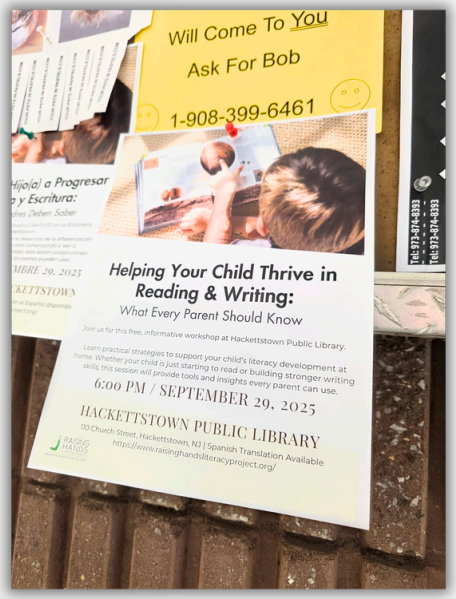


Only 1 in 16 children with a learning disability receives federally funded special education services

IEP AND SCHOOL ADVOCACY

Families consistently share how confusing and stressful it can be to access school-based supports. Our advocacy program responds to that need by offering free, accessible guidance—helping parents prepare for IEP meetings, understand intervention options, feel confident speaking with the school team and empowered to advocate for their child. By hosting open sessions at the library and providing one-on-one support, we've created a trusted space where families can ask questions, gain clarity, and feel empowered.





62% of parents report struggling to understand the IEP/MTSS process, and 70% say they need more guidance navigating services

COMING IN 2026

This year we will be...

..expanding our community-based early literacy programming to laundromat and church locations, providing families with free, non-religious school-readiness and literacy support in trusted neighborhood spaces.



..expanding our advocacy support—offering more parent training, IEP preparation, and free guidance sessions for families navigating the education system.

..enjoying our new (bigger!) tutoring center in Hackettstown.



..continuing and expanding our after school enrichment/STEM and homework help.



What They're Saying About Us



I thank God for this wonderful program, which has been a blessing for our daughter. She has truly made significant progress and has caught up to her grade level. We received excellent grades this past semester, and her teachers are amazed at how much she has improved. We, as parents, are so grateful to the Raising Hands program, and we hope that more children in need, like our daughter, will have the same opportunity she has had. Thank you to you and the entire team who works with you.

My child's reading fluency and comprehension improved dramatically after she received high-quality tutoring services through Raising Hands. I can't say enough positive things about their ability to improve students' reading and writing abilities. Holly's tireless commitment to improving literacy education makes such a difference for teachers, students, schools, and communities.

A program that has been a great blessing for my daughters. The staff is very friendly, and I have truly seen academic progress in my daughters, helping them develop their learning and language skills and achieve stronger academic growth. Thank God for the life of each member of the team and for the director, Holly.



PARTNERS

THANK you!

We proudly partner with the following community locations to serve underserved children in New Jersey, Minnesota and Long Island.

bright*lings

HACKETTSTOWN FREE PUBLIC LIBRARY

TRINITY United Methodist Church

THE LAUNDRY BASKET

OUR GENEROUS DONORS!